PayWatch — Intern Hiring Kit

Interview questions, benchmark answers, and role plans for evaluating and onboarding interns.

How to run each interview

- Keep it to 15–20 minutes and make the candidate comfortable — you want their real self, not a rehearsed one.
- Ask for examples and stories, not opinions ("tell me about a time…" beats "do you think…").
- Mention the actual work they'd do (from the role plan below) and gauge their reaction — excitement is a good sign.
- Prioritise drive, ownership and coachability over polish. Skills can be taught in a few weeks; attitude can't.
- Give a small real scenario or task where you can, and watch how they think, not just the final answer.

Common questions (ask every candidate)

Q1. Why do you want to join an early-stage startup like PayWatch?

Strong answer: *Genuine interest in fintech/startups; wants ownership and to learn; understands early-stage is scrappy and unstructured; excited by impact. Red flag: only wants a certificate/CV line, or knows nothing about PayWatch.*

Q2. What do you know about PayWatch and personal finance?

Strong answer: *Did some homework — can describe what the app does, shows curiosity about money/fintech. Red flag: didn't bother to look it up.*

Q3. How many hours a week can you realistically commit, and how do you handle self-driven, unstructured work?

Strong answer: *Honest about hours (e.g. 10–15), is a self-starter, comfortable with ambiguity, gives an example of managing their own time. Red flag: over-promises hours or needs constant hand-holding.*

Q4. Tell me about something you built, led, or took initiative on.

Strong answer: *A concrete example (a project, club, event, side hustle) showing ownership and follow-through. Red flag: vague, no real example.*

Marketing & Growth

What they'll do (role plan)

- Run PayWatch's social media (Instagram, LinkedIn, X) — content calendar, posting, engagement.
- Grow the waitlist / signups; run campus activations and referral campaigns.
- Basic app-store optimisation (ASO) and SEO; email & WhatsApp campaigns.
- Track growth metrics (signups, reach, conversion, CAC) and report weekly.
- Experiment across channels, measure, and double down on what works.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. How would you get PayWatch its first 500 users with almost no budget?

Strong answer: *Talks about organic/community/campus channels, referral loops, the free "Money Health Score" as a shareable hook, and content — not just "run ads." Sees zero-budget as a creativity challenge.*

Q2. Which social platform would you prioritise for a personal-finance app aimed at young Indians, and why?

Strong answer: *A reasoned choice (e.g. Instagram for reach + LinkedIn for credibility) tied to where the audience is — not a random pick.*

Q3. Tell me about a post, page, or campaign you grew or that performed well.

Strong answer: *A concrete example with some numbers, and an understanding of what actually drove the result.*

Q4. How would you measure whether your marketing is working?

Strong answer: *Names real metrics (signups, click-through, conversion, retention) — not just likes and vanity numbers.*

Q5. A campaign flops — zero signups. What do you do next?
Strong answer: *Diagnoses (audience / message / channel), iterates with data, and doesn't give up.*

Market & User Research

What they'll do (role plan)

- Competitor analysis (INDmoney, Groww, ClearTax, Jupiter, etc.) — features, pricing, positioning.
- Run user interviews and surveys; synthesise pain points; build user personas.
- Market sizing, segmentation, and pricing research.
- Turn findings into clear, actionable reports that feed product and marketing.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. How would you find out whether people actually want PayWatch — before we build more?
Strong answer: *Talks to real users, runs surveys, tests a landing page, observes behaviour — and distinguishes what people say from what they do.*

Q2. Name a few competitors and how you'd compare them.
Strong answer: *Names real ones (INDmoney, Groww, ClearTax) and proposes a structured comparison (features / price / audience).*

Q3. You interview 10 users — how do you turn that into something useful for us?
Strong answer: *Synthesises into themes, quantifies, and gives actionable insights — not just raw quotes.*

Q4. How would you spot a pain point that users can't put into words?
Strong answer: *Watches behaviour, asks "why" repeatedly, and looks for the workarounds people have built.*

Q5. What makes a survey question bad?
Strong answer: *Understands leading, loaded, or double-barrelled questions and response bias.*

Content & Design

What they'll do (role plan)

- Create social posts, graphics, reels / short videos, infographics and brand creatives.
- Write simple personal-finance educational content (carousels, captions, blogs).
- Maintain brand consistency (colours, fonts, tone); design posters and ads.
- Help with in-app copy and product demo videos.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. Show me your portfolio or something you designed or created.
Strong answer: *Has samples and can explain the choices behind them.*

Q2. How would you explain "why you need term insurance" in a 15-second reel?
Strong answer: *Simple, hook-first, relatable, jargon-free — proves they can make finance easy to understand.*

Q3. How do you keep a brand looking consistent across many posts?
Strong answer: *Mentions a palette, fonts, templates, and tone guidelines.*

Q4. Design a post that gets students to check their Money Health Score — walk me through the idea.
Strong answer: *Clear hook, audience-aware, with a call to action.*

Q5. How do you take feedback on your creative work?
Strong answer: *Not precious about it — iterates and separates ego from the work (coachability).*

Product & Feedback

What they'll do (role plan)

- Recruit users, run usability tests, and gather & organise feedback.

- Log bugs and feature requests; help prioritise the roadmap.
- QA the app; analyse onboarding and engagement; do competitor product teardowns.
- Write clear feedback summaries and user stories for the founder.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. You watch someone use PayWatch for the first time and they get confused on a screen. What do you do?
Strong answer: *Observes without jumping in to help, notes where and why, asks about it afterwards, and reports it — doesn't blame the user.*

Q2. How would you decide which feature we build next?
Strong answer: *Weighs impact vs effort and how often/severely users feel the pain — not just "what I'd like."*

Q3. Tell me about an app you love and one thing you'd change about it.
Strong answer: *Thoughtful critique that shows product sense.*

Q4. How do you gather feedback without leading the user to the answer you want?
Strong answer: *Uses open questions and observation, and avoids leading.*

Q5. You have 50 pieces of feedback — how do you make sense of them?
Strong answer: *Groups into themes and prioritises by frequency and severity.*

Business & Outreach

What they'll do (role plan)

- Outreach to potential partners (insurance infra, mutual-fund platforms, colleges).
- Run a campus ambassador programme; cold emails/DMs, lead gen, and simple CRM tracking.
- Coordinate events and summit participation; support accelerator/incubation applications and pitch materials.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. You need a meeting with a busy company or partner. How do you approach it?
Strong answer: *Concise, value-first outreach, personalised, persistent, and uses warm intros where possible.*

Q2. Sell me PayWatch in 60 seconds.
Strong answer: *Clear, confident, benefit-led — tests real communication skill.*

Q3. Tell me about a time you convinced someone or closed something (a sponsor, a deal, an event).
Strong answer: *A genuine example of persuasion or closing.*

Q4. How would you run a campus ambassador programme?
Strong answer: *Structured thinking — recruit, incentivise, target, and track.*

Q5. A partner says no. What next?
Strong answer: *Asks why, learns from it, follows up — not discouraged.*

Finance & Domain

What they'll do (role plan)

- Verify and improve the tax, insurance and investing content for accuracy; sanity-check calculations.
- Research regulatory and rule updates (SEBI / RBI / IRDAI / income tax); keep the knowledge base current.
- Create financial-education content; validate domain logic; research competitor financial products.

Interview questions & what a strong answer looks like

Q1. Explain the difference between the old and new tax regime, simply.
Strong answer: *Correct, clear, and simple — shows real understanding and the ability to teach it.*

Q2. Why might someone be under-insured, and how would you check?
Strong answer: *Understands cover adequacy (e.g. term ≈ 10–15× income, adequate health cover) and is practical about it.*

Q3. How do most people invest, and what's the difference between a distributor and an adviser?
Strong answer: *A reasonable grasp of mutual funds / SIPs and the MFD-vs-RIA distinction.*

Q4. How would you make sure our financial content stays accurate and current?
Strong answer: *Cites official sources, cross-checks, and keeps up with changes.*

Q5. How would you explain a complex finance concept to a total beginner?
Strong answer: *Uses analogies and avoids jargon.*

Quick scoring sheet (rate each 1–5)

Score each candidate on these; strong hires are 3+ across the board, with role skill and drive weighing most.

Criterion	What to look for	Score /5
Motivation & fit	Genuine interest, understands early-stage, wants to build not just tick a box	
Role-specific skill	Can actually do the core work of the role (or learn it fast)	
Communication	Explains ideas clearly and simply — crucial for a beginner-facing product	
Ownership & initiative	Has taken things on and followed through without being told	
Coachability	Takes feedback well, curious, self-aware	
Commitment	Realistic hours and can sustain it alongside studies	